to achieve low positivity rates in their respective districts in the hope of restarting activity.

This time around, when the prime minister appeared on television for his scheduled national address, he was seen repurposing his scarf as a face mask. Before beginning to speak, he lowered it and wrapped it around his neck. This was a predecided move by him. The emerging science that he had read was strongly recommending mask usage which had the potential of reducing travel of viral load in aerosol droplets up to a factor of two.[37] Although the MoHFW had already published mask guidelines on 3 April, the usage was still low and to penetrate to more people the prime minister decided to demonstrate it. He decided to repurpose his scarf to display that a home-made mask too can be very effective. This would also increase the sales of cloth masks, offering the much-needed employment generation opportunities to self-help groups. Later, he would also use a picture of his in a cloth mask as his Twitter display picture, leaving it unchanged until India administered one billion vaccine doses.

In the address, he sympathized with the pain of the people and presented India's positive report card as compared to other wealthier nations, only because of the bold, drastic steps we had taken very early on. He went on and presented seven mantras, appealing to the people to continue to maintain lockdown discipline until 3 May. His seven mantras were: taking care of the elderly since they were most vulnerable to the infection, following social distancing, staying at home and wearing masks, following instructions from AYUSH ministry to enhance immunity like consuming warm water and kadha (Ayurvedic home remedy), downloading the Aarogya Setu app, taking care of the poor around us and offering as much help as possible, being compassionate to employees and not cutting them off the payroll and last, following lockdown rules until 3 May, by staying put.[38]